The Heart of Ghana

First mention of 'heart' is Gen 6:5 when God referred to it as only evil continually.

Jer 17:9 says the heart is deceitful above all things and desperately wicked and unknowable

Acts 8: 9-23

Simon was a man with a back-ground very much like Ghana:

1) Sorcery + witchcraft
(10-11) Assigning power based upon fear
(13) Accepted Christ's sacrifice but never really changed his mind - SW parody
(18-19) Valued money over maturity
(21) Heart out of alignment with God
(22-24) On the verge of judgement, in need of repentance, and future unclear

Where did Simon go wrong?
vs 20 → thinking God's gift was something to be gained transactionally.

He had no humility and believed himself equal to God when he believed the his money in his pocket could bring the mighty power of God to bear.

His lack of humility led to two separate ailments that cost Simon his part in the Kingdom - building process (that most high calling that rests upon each of us).

Gall of Bitterness

Gall is directly connected in Deut 29:18 to leaving God's will and service to chase after other gods.

In Deut 32:32 God warns that this gall is linked to Sodom & Gomorrah

Jeremiah shows us that gall is something God feeds His rebellious children to shake them awake

In Amos God says that His own rebellious children corrupt judgement with gall.

What is gall? Venom / poison / poisonous
Where does it originate?
Envy / resentment / jealousy

Gall starts as a root that bears gall and wormwood as a fruit (Deut 29:18)

Bitterness: unmanaged resentments

Resentments: our pride pushing away the reality that someone else was treated better than us

Gall - pride
Bitterness - pride
Book of Jonah - punishment for pride
Simon (like Ghana) had a heart filled with pride

What is the cure?

Repent + pray (Acts 8:22)

Repent - think differently

What did Simon need to repent?

Peter said wickedness and the thought (purpose) of his heart

What do you and I need to repent if we are to be used of God and blessed of God like Peter + John?

1) our definition of success
- Simon believed the price of salvation was dominance over others.
- Ghana has long equated success with Western wealth

What if Simon (with his influence) had remained in God's will and became more like Christ as he grew and less like those around him in Samaria?

What if Ghana, with all its influence in Africa, became more Christ-like and less western-influenced? What could Ghana do for Africa?

Simon was positioned to reach all of Samaria ... and he failed because his definition of success was wrong.

Micah 6:8
Ecc 12:13
John 3:33
} Success God's way

2) His method of obtaining that success was wrong

God had a plan and a purpose for a spirit-filled Simon. He had been patient, learned to submit to God in humility over time, he likely would have been SF over all Samaria in Samaria like Jesus the brother of Jesus WHO, BY THE WAY, SENT PETER AND JOHN!!

Instead Simon chose the Aquaintance ... the short path.

God has a plan and a purpose for a Spirit-filled Ghana.

Micah 6:8
Ecc 12:13
John 3:33
} God's plan for success for Ghana

Properly positioned before God, with patience and humility, Ghana could become the Beacon of Hope for all of Africa.

If we are to be useful and powerful in the Kingdom of God we must change
1- our definition of success
2- our method of obtaining success

3) What we will do with that success when achieved

Simon was not interested in HAVING the power of God... he was interested in selling the power of God.
- CHOPPING THE SEEDS
- EMA'S TOMATOES

This is what we have here in Ghana as our religious leaders. This is what we have in Ghana here as political leaders. A bunch of godless seed choppers

Stop chopping the SEEDS

We must repent of the thought (purpose) of our heart...

Micah 6:8
Ecc 12:13
John 3:33